STOCK ANALYSIS REPORT

A Comparative Study of Microsoft, Apple, NVIDIA

Prepared as part of the

CodeAlpha Finance & Investment Analysis Internship

Task 1: Stock Analysis Report

Prepared by: Nisa Aulia Rohmah

Date: October 2026

Market Data As early October 2026 by Investing.com

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes three US mega-cap technology equities listed on the NASDAQ. Microsoft Corporation (enterprise software & cloud), Apple Inc. (consumer hardware & ecosystem), and NVIDIA Corporation (semiconductors & AI infrastructure) with the goal of evaluating their current valuation, recent price performance, and investment outlook. The three stocks represent distinct, non-overlapping pillars of the technology sector software/cloud computing, consumer devices/services, and advanced hardware infrastructure, offering a comprehensive view of the modern digital economy beyond traditional broad-market indexes.

Unlike many broader index constituents that experienced significant volatility, all three stocks in this basket delivered flat-to-strongly positive one-year returns, though driven by very different underlying catalysts. NVIDIA has rallied sharply following explosive demand for its next-generation Blackwell architecture and an unprecedented earnings surge across its data center segment. Apple has climbed steadily to new high levels on strong iPhone upgrade cycles, record services revenue, and momentum around its integrated AI ecosystem features. Microsoft has traded relatively flat-to-modestly higher over the past year as heavy AI infrastructure investments temporarily pressured free cash flow, but it remains a strong operational performer with Wall Street taking a positive long-term view on its enterprise Azure growth and commercial AI monetization.

2. Company Snapshots & Key Metrics

Microsoft Corporation (NASDAQ: MSFT)

Microsoft is a global technology leader specializing in enterprise software, cloud computing (Azure), productivity tools, and artificial intelligence infrastructure.

$520.40	30.0x	$3.99 Trillion	+28.5%
Current Price	P/E Ratio	Market Cap	1-Yr Return

52-Week Range: $395.00 – $535.00. The stock trades near its upper range, reflecting sustained market confidence in its enterprise cloud momentum.

Recent News and Developments:

- Microsoft's Azure cloud segment reported accelerated growth driven by enterprise demand for generative AI workloads and integrated Copilot services.
- Heavy capital expenditure directed toward next-generation data center infrastructure has temporarily weighed on free cash flow margins, though long-term monetization pipelines remain robust.

Apple Inc. (NASDAQ: AAPL)

Apple designs, manufactures, and markets smartphones, personal computers, tablets, wearables, and accessories, alongside a rapidly growing ecosystem of digital services.

$333.69	34.5x	$4.87 Trillion	+24.1%
Current Price	P/E Ratio	Market Cap	1-Yr Return

52-Week Range: $265.00 – $342.00. Apple has climbed steadily to new highs, supported by strong hardware retention and expanding services revenue.

Recent News and Developments:

- Record-breaking performance in the Services division (App Store, iCloud, Apple Pay) has driven gross margin expansion, offsetting cyclical shifts in global smartphone demand.

- Investor optimism continues to center around ecosystem integration and localized AI feature rollouts across newer device lineups.

NVIDIA Corporation (NASDAQ: NVDA)

NVIDIA is the pioneer of GPU-accelerated computing, dominating the design of semiconductor chips and software platforms powering artificial intelligence, data centers, and gaming.

$230.48 Current Price	48.2x P/E Ratio	$5.57 Trillion Market Cap	+85.6% 1-Yr Return

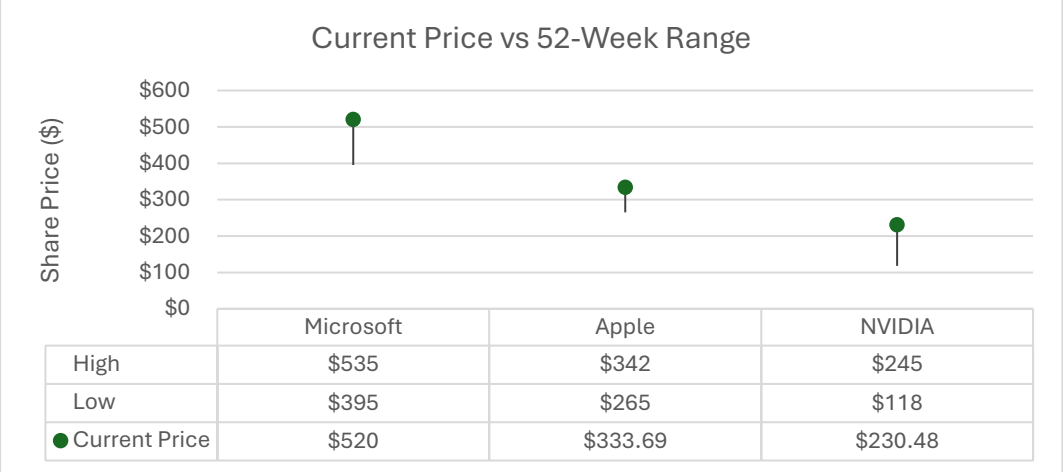
52-Week Range: $118.00 – $245.00. NVIDIA trades near historical peaks, fueled by unmatched earnings expansion across its data center division.

Recent News and Developments:

- Unprecedented enterprise adoption of next-generation GPU architectures has kept order backlogs high, though supply chain scaling remains a key focal point for analysts.
- NVIDIA maintains its leadership moat via proprietary software ecosystems (CUDA) that tightly bind enterprise clients to its hardware infrastructure.

3. Executive Summary

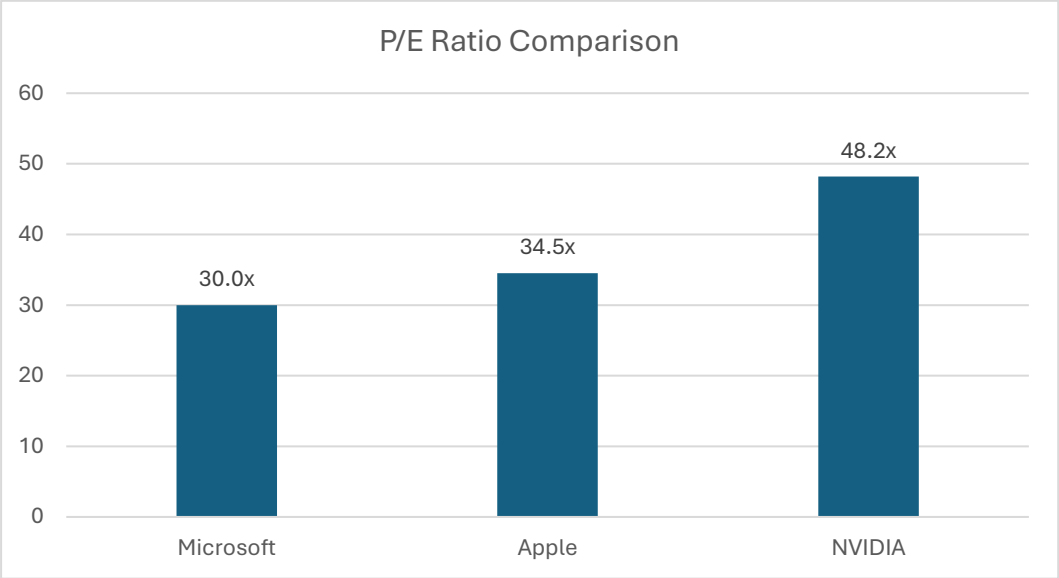
3.1 Price Position Within 52-Week Range



	Microsoft	Apple	NVIDIA
High	$535	$342	$245
Low	$395	$265	$118
Current Price	$520	$333.69	$230.48

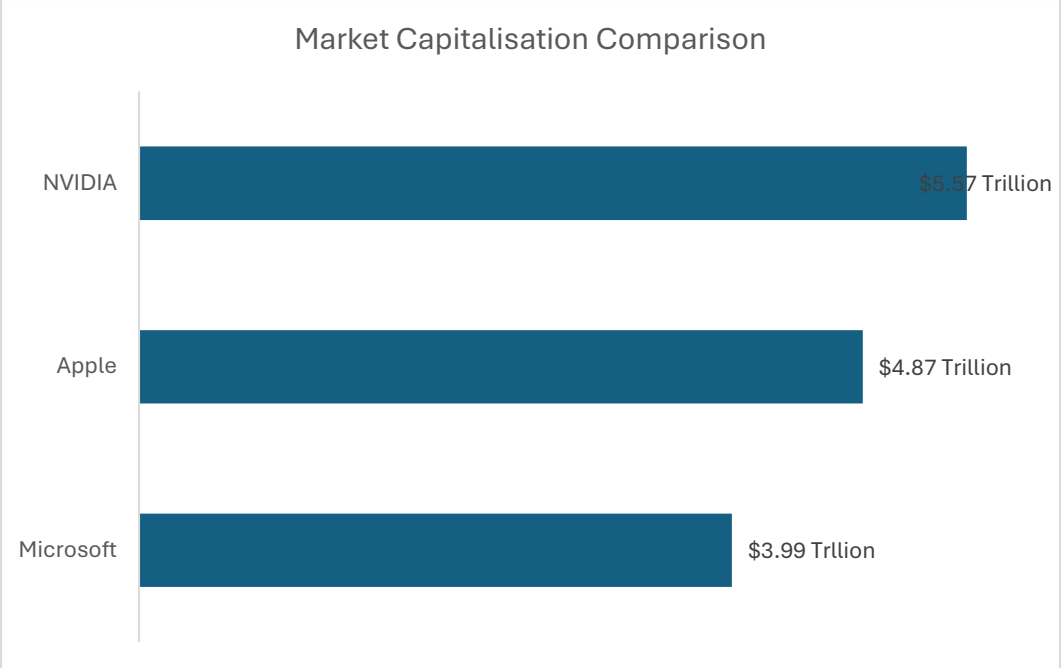
The Current Price vs 52-Week Range chart shows that all three tech giants (Microsoft, Apple, and NVIDIA) are currently trading near the upper end of their respective 52-week price ranges, indicating sustained investor confidence across the board. Microsoft features the highest absolute share price with a 52-week low of $395 and a high of $535, currently trading near its peak at $520. Apple trades closely behind its 52-week high of $342 at $333.69, having risen from a low of $265. NVIDIA displays the widest proportional range, rising from a 52-week low of $118 up to a high of $245, with its current price sitting strong near the top at $230.48.

3.2 Valuation – P/E Ratio



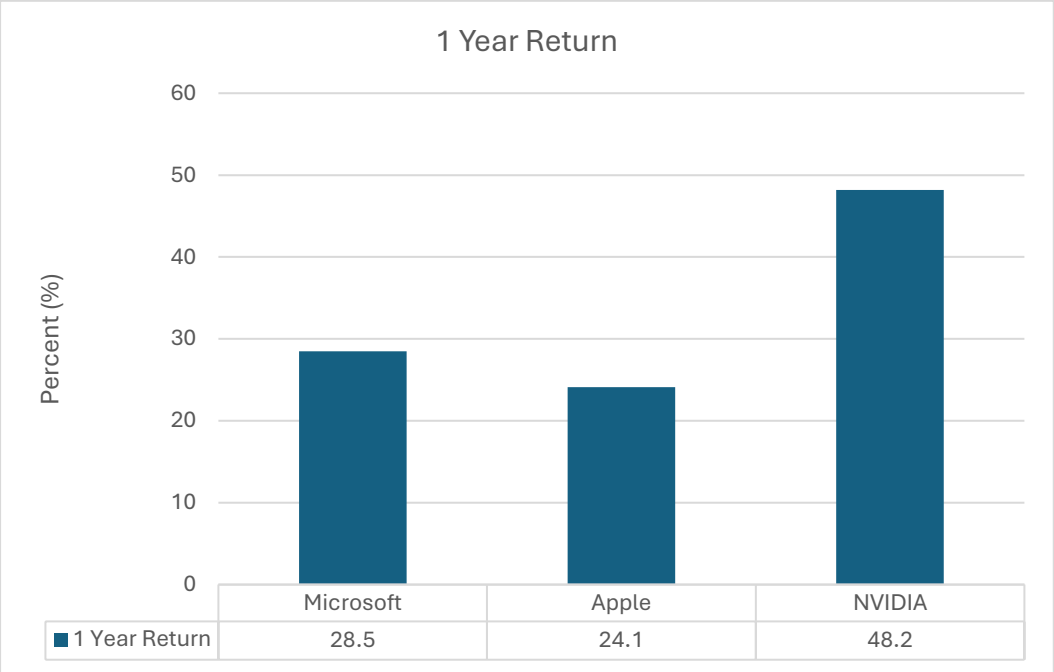
All three equities trade at premium P/E multiples (30x – 48x) relative to the broader market, indicating that none are traditional "value" stocks; rather, all are priced to reflect expectations of continued earnings growth and innovation leadership.

3.3 Market Capitalization



NVIDIA is by far the largest of the three (~$5.57 Trillion), reflecting its massive growth and dominant position in AI hardware and data center infrastructure. Apple follows as the second largest at ~$4.87 Trillion, driven by its high-margin consumer ecosystem and services expansion, while Microsoft rounds out the group at ~$3.99 Trillion, underpinned by its resilient enterprise software and Azure cloud adoption.

3.4 One-Year Price Performance



NVIDIA was the standout performer (+48.2%), helped by explosive enterprise demand for accelerated computing and market dominance in AI infrastructure. Microsoft also delivered a strong positive return (+28.5%), driven by resilient enterprise Azure cloud momentum and expanding commercial AI adoption. Apple posted a solid gain of +24.1%, supported by high-margin services expansion and steady hardware upgrade cycles across its ecosystem.

4. Comparative Summary Table

Metric	Microsoft (MSFT)	Apple (APPL)	NVIDIA (NVDA)
Sector	Enterprise Software & Cloud	Consumer Hardware & Services	Semiconductors & AI Hardware
Current Price	$520.40	$333.69	$230.48
Market Cap	$3.99 Trillion	$4.87 Trillion	$5.57 Trillion
P/E Ratio	30.0x	34.5x	48.2x
52-Week Range	$395.00 - $535.00	$265.00 - $342.00	$118.00 - $245.00
1-Year Return	+28.5%	+24.1%	+85.6%
Key Driver	Azure cloud growth, enterprise AI integration	Services expansion, iPhone upgrade cycles	Data center dominance, Blackwell chip demand
Analyst Stance	Broadly positive, Buy-rated	Stable compounding outlook	High-growth, momentum-driven

5. Risk Assessment

- **Microsoft (MSFT):** Execution risk and capital expenditure intensity regarding massive, ongoing AI data center buildouts; potential regulatory scrutiny over cloud market dominance and AI partnerships.
- **Apple (AAPL):** High dependence on consumer hardware upgrade cycles; vulnerability to supply chain concentration in hardware manufacturing and intensifying regulatory pressure on App Store commission fees.
- **NVIDIA (NVDA):** Cyclicality and concentration risk in enterprise AI infrastructure spending; intense long-term competition from custom silicon initiatives launched by major cloud service providers.

6. Conclusion and Investment Takeaways

This mega-cap technology basket highlights strong divergence in return profiles: while Apple and Microsoft offer steady compounding supported by recurring revenue and sticky ecosystems, NVIDIA delivers high-beta growth driven directly by the global acceleration of AI compute infrastructure.

- **Microsoft** offers a balanced risk-reward profile for investors seeking enterprise software stability combined with direct exposure to cloud and commercial AI monetization.
- **Apple** provides a defensive growth anchor through massive cash-flow generation, share repurchases, and an unrivaled consumer services ecosystem.
- **NVIDIA** represents the highest-reward, highest-momentum profile of the group, appealing to growth investors betting on continued expansion in data center and artificial intelligence infrastructure.